Staffing Note Convention

Use the right prefix. Improve reporting. Keep notes simple.

Goal: Choose the correct prefix for common staffing events.

The one rule

The prefix goes first, including the period. The rest of the note stays the same.

PREFIX. + Your normal note

Example

CG CANCEL. CG can't make it today due to a family emergency. Looking for coverage now. - NC

Nothing else changes.



Nine prefixes, four simple buckets

Learn the situation first. The exact prefix becomes easier to remember.

Caregiver availability

TORF.

Planned time off

CG CANCEL.

Cancels with notice

NCNS.

No show, no call

Client decision

CL CANCEL.

Client cancels visit

NO REPL.

No coverage needed

CL REFUSED.

Replacement declined

Schedule solution

RESCHED.

Visit moved

Coverage work

ATT.

Call, text, voicemail

CG DECLINED.

Caregiver says no

Quick decision guide: Who cancelled?

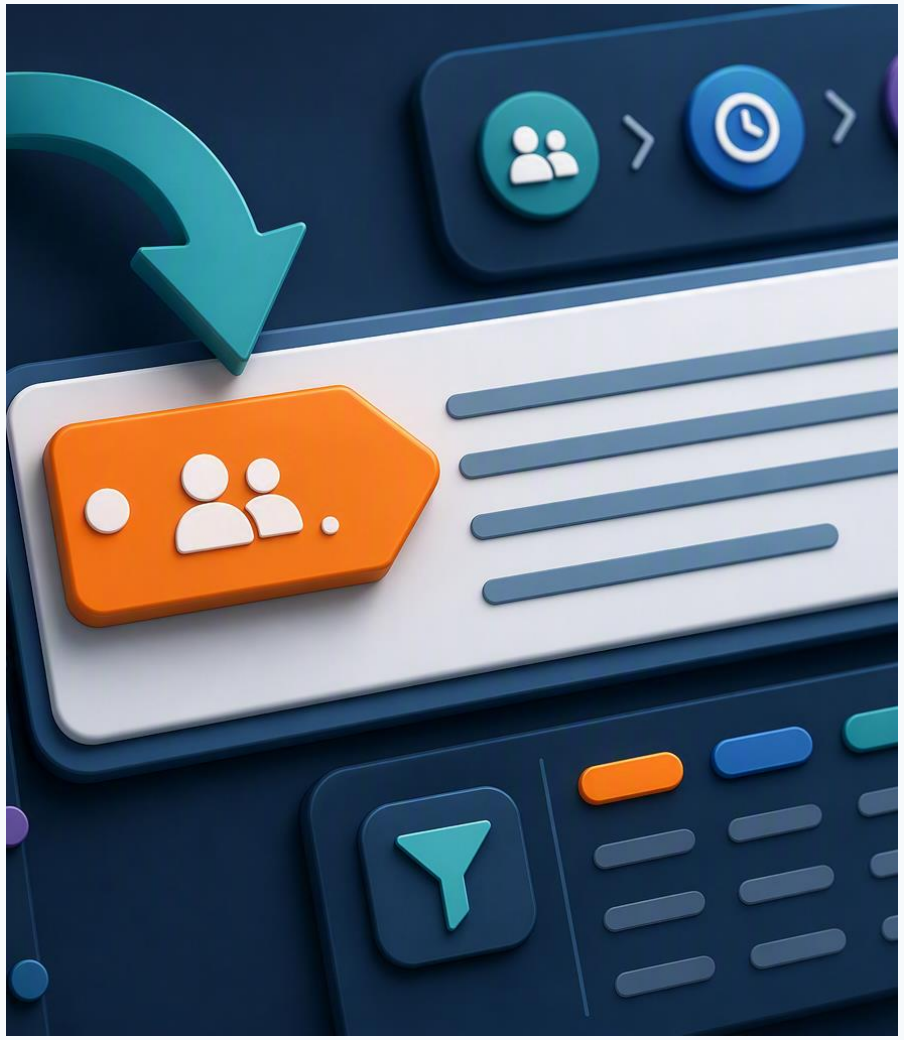
Start with the person or event that caused the disruption.



Planned days off requested in advance are different: use TORF.

What happened after the cancellation?

Use a separate note for each new event or action.



NO REPL.	Client says coverage is not needed.
CL REFUSED.	A replacement was offered, and the client declined.
RESCHED.	The visit was moved to another time or day.
ATT.	Each call, text, or voicemail made for coverage.
CG DECLINED.	A caregiver was offered the shift and said no.

Three habits to remember

Accurate prefixes make staffing reporting consistent and fair.

1

One prefix per note

If two things happen, write two notes.

2

Keep activity tags

Prefixes complement tags. They do not replace them.

3

Use only the approved list

New prefixes require a formal SOP update.

Start with the correct prefix. Then document exactly as you do today.